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Cook County sheriff's police officers ride the CTA "L" Green Line on Wednesday through Oak Park and Chicago's West Side in an effort to deter crime and nuisance violations on the transit system. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Dart signals support for dedicated transit police

County sheriff wants task force to use new state funding to create agency

By Talia Soglin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Cook County Sheriff Tom Dart, whose police officers have been deployed on the CTA for several months, said Wednesday that a dedicated police force should be responsible for law enforcement on public transit.

Sheriff's police have been deployed on the CTA since the spring, when the mass transit agency beefed up law enforcement staffing at the behest of the federal government. About 50 sworn offi-

cers work the transit system a day, the sheriff's office said this week.

Dart's office is also leading a law enforcement task force mandated by the state's landmark transit funding and reform legislation, which took effect at the beginning of June. The law is expected to raise more than \$1 billion for public transit annually and creates the new Northern Illinois Transit Authority to govern the CTA, Metra and Pace. NITA, as it will be called, is expected to be a more powerful version of the existing Regional Transportation Author-

ity. One provision of the law: The task force led by the sheriff's office must create a report of recommendations regarding law enforcement strategies on transit and "make recommendations" to be used "in implementing a sworn law enforcement officer crime prevention program" on mass transit.

Later, NITA will vote on implementing such a program, the law says.

In an interview with the Tribune as part of a media blitz this week, Dart signaled his support for a dedicated law enforcement

agency for mass transit that would be paid for with new transit funding, although he acknowledged a number of options were on the table.

"Whatever ends up being our final plan, it has to have one person that is ultimately responsible," he said, describing the current system as "bifurcated."

Currently, law enforcement on the CTA includes a combination of members of the Chicago Police Department's mass transit units,

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Trump irked by vote on Iran war

In meeting, president berates GOP 'losers' as tensions escalate

By Mary Clare Jalonick,
Steven Sloan,
Joey Cappelletti
and Lisa Mascaro
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump berated Senate Republicans during a visit to the Capitol on Wednesday for allowing a vote to block his war in Iran, further escalating a feud that has diverted GOP efforts to focus on election-year affordability issues and brought much of the chamber's business to a halt.

Invited to speak at the GOP luncheon by Florida Sen. Rick Scott, Trump had signaled ahead of time that he would use the closed-door meeting to push senators to pass his proof-of-citizenship voting bill. But the conversation was more focused on Tuesday's vote to approve the war powers resolution, a mostly symbolic measure that allows Congress to rebuke the administration's military actions. The House passed its own version of the resolution earlier this month.

Trump had particular words for the four Republican senators who voted with Democrats on the measure — Lisa Murkowski of Alaska, Susan Collins of Maine, Rand Paul of Kentucky and Bill Cassidy of Louisiana — after calling them "losers" on social media.

Most Republicans stayed quiet. But Cassidy, who lost reelection in his primary last

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■ United States and Iran embroiled in "war of words"
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Pritzker signs law limiting access to abortion records

By Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Gov. JB Pritzker signed a measure into law Wednesday shielding patients from having electronic medical records related to abortion and other reproductive health services received in Illinois disclosed without their consent to out-of-state providers.

Marking the fourth anniversary of the U.S. Supreme Court's "devastating" Dobbs decision that overturned the federal right to abortion, Pritzker promoted the legislation — approved in the Illinois General Assembly in late May largely along party lines — as the latest Democratic effort to push back against restrictions enacted at the federal level and in other states. Some states have enacted criminal penalties for providers and for people who

assist patients traveling out of state to receive abortions.

"A woman seeking care should not have to wonder whether her private health information could be used against her," Pritzker said during a news conference at the state's West Loop headquarters. "A healthcare provider should not have to fear that patient records will become a tool for political prosecution and persecution, and no state should be allowed to weaponize medical information in an effort to undermine rights that are protected here."

The new law requires electronic medical records providers, such as Wisconsin-based Epic Systems, which makes MyChart, to segregate data on abortion-related services received in Illinois and prohibit that information

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'It felt like it wasn't enough'

By Rebecca Johnson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Shaeve White couldn't fall asleep. There was a feeling deep in her gut that something wasn't right.

Tired of tossing and turning, she dragged herself out of bed and sat in her office. That's when she got a call from her grandma. Between tears and the sounds of police in the background, she told White that her mom had been killed in a hit-and-run.

Frustrated with police, Sauk Village woman searches social media for alleged driver in mom's deadly hit-and-run

White remembers thinking that she'd never heard her grandma cry before.

"I haven't been the same since, honestly," the 34-year-old Sauk Village resident said.

About four months after Shanna White, 50, was fatally struck by a vehicle in Winthrop Harbor, near the Wisconsin border, the police department announced on Monday that the alleged driver turned himself in

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Shaeve White, above, holds a photo of her mother, Shanna White, outside her home in Sauk Village on Wednesday. Shanna was killed in a hit-and run while walking along Sheridan Road in Winthrop Harbor in February. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CHICAGOLAND

Video gaming a sticking point

A hearing on reversing the city's legalization of video gambling terminals ended abruptly Wednesday after protests from opponents of Mayor Brandon Johnson escalated into a call for a commissioner to resign. Johnson wants aldermen to authorize an agreement with Bally's that would ban video gambling terminals.

SPORTS

More rotation mess for Cubs

At this point, the Cubs might need to look to the stands for healthy bodies to put in their rotation. The Cubs placed right-handers Ben Brown and Edward Cabrera on the injured list before Wednesday's doubleheader in New York. It's a devastating blow for a pitching staff that has been decimated by injuries.

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